

ings, and stripped women of their clothing and beat them with clubs and he killed many priests there,

and, in their hatred, to commit slaughter and murder upon the clergy who rightfully communicated with the blessed Symmachus and they killed with the sword publicly those who were found within the city. Also they expelled consecrated women and virgins from their convents and their dwellings and they stripped women of their clothing and wounded them with blows and stripes; and daily they waged war against the church in the midst of the city. Likewise they slew many priests,

among them Dignissimus and Gordianus,¹ priests of Saint ² Peter, the apostle, "ad Vincula," and of Saints John and Paul, whom they did to death with cudgels and sword; also many other Christians, so that it was unsafe for one of the clergy to walk abroad in the city by day or by night. Only Faustus, the exconsul, fought for the church.

After all this the blessed Symmachus found Manicheans in the city of Rome and burned with fire all their images and books before

state of lawlessness and tumult which lasted during the years before Symmachus was finally and decisively reinstated. The people as a whole seem to have supported Symmachus but a party of the clergy and a majority of the Senate were bitter against him.

¹ The name of Dignissimus does not appear on the list of parish priests who took part in the synod of 499, perhaps because the basilica which he served was not counted among the parish churches. Gordianus is registered as priest of Santi Giovanni e Paolo. He was the father of Pope Agapitus. *Infra*, p. 143 and n. 6. Both undoubtedly perished early in the disturbances, for neither was among the priests loyal to Symmachus who attended the synod of November, 502. Duchesne, *op. cit.*, p. 265, n. 13.

² From the sixth century onward the word "sanctus" was an official title, applied only to the distinguished dead who were publicly venerated in the churches, no longer a general epithet for all bishops or even, as in primitive times, for all believers, living or dead. Hereafter, therefore, in our text the word will usually be translated "saint," instead of the vaguer "holy."

³ The church of San Pietro in Vincoli was built during the fifth century by the empress Eudoxia to receive the relic of the chains of Peter.